

HOI4 Mod Cleanup Instructions (Country-by-Country)

Work through the mod one country at a time. Do **not** move to the next country until the current one has been completely analyzed and cleaned.

Goal

Remove all dead code, unused assets, and obsolete content while preserving all functionality currently used by the mod.

Only remove content when you can verify it is no longer referenced or can never execute.

For each country

1. National Focuses

Inspect every focus tree associated with the country.

Remove:

- Entire focus trees that can never appear (for example `allow_branch = { always = no }`).
- Focuses that are impossible to unlock because no valid path reaches them.
- Commented-out focuses.
- Duplicate or abandoned focus implementations.
- Focuses that are never referenced by the active tree.

Update prerequisite chains after removing focuses.

2. Events

Inspect all country-related events.

Remove events that are:

- Never fired.
- Never referenced.
- Not called from focuses, decisions, on_actions, scripted effects, or other events.
- Leftover test events.
- Completely replaced by newer implementations.

Verify there are no remaining references before deleting.

3. On Actions

Inspect all on_actions.

Remove:

- Entries pointing to deleted events.
- Empty handlers.
- Duplicate registrations.
- Legacy hooks that are no longer used.

4. Ideas / Spirits

Inspect:

- ideas
- spirits
- country modifiers

Remove any that are:

- Never granted.
- Never removed.
- Never referenced.
- Leftover placeholders.

5. Characters

Inspect all characters.

Remove characters that are:

- Never recruited.
- Never assigned.
- Never spawned.
- No longer referenced anywhere.

6. Scripted Content

Inspect:

- scripted effects

- scripted triggers
- scripted loc
- scripted GUIs
- variables
- utility scripts

Remove any scripted object that has zero remaining references.

7. Decisions

Inspect all decisions.

Remove:

- Unreachable decisions.
 - Hidden legacy decisions.
 - Decisions with impossible visibility/availability.
 - Unreferenced decision categories.
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8. Dynamic Modifiers

Inspect all dynamic modifiers.

Remove any modifier that is never applied.

9. Localization

After code cleanup:

Remove localization for:

- Deleted focuses
- Deleted events
- Deleted ideas
- Deleted spirits
- Deleted decisions
- Deleted characters
- Deleted modifiers
- Deleted scripted content

Also remove duplicate localization and orphaned keys.

10. Assets

Remove orphaned:

- GFX
- portraits
- icons
- focus icons
- event pictures
- interface references

Only remove assets with no remaining references.

Reference Search

Before deleting anything, search the entire project for references, including:

- focuses
- events
- on_actions
- scripted effects
- scripted triggers
- decisions
- ideas
- characters
- modifiers
- GUI
- localization
- defines
- variables

Assume indirect references are valid until proven otherwise.

Report

At the end of each country, produce a report containing:

Deleted

- Focuses
- Events
- Ideas
- Spirits
- Characters
- Scripted effects

- Scripted triggers
- Decisions
- Localization keys
- Assets

Updated

- Files modified
- References fixed
- Prerequisites updated

Remaining

List anything that appears unused but could not be safely removed because its usage could not be verified.

Do not proceed to the next country until this report is complete.